

OFFICIAL PUBLICATION OF PORT ELIZABETH CAMERA CLUB

LUMEN

April 2026



Image of the Month

"Light Lunch" by Jay Nabbe



Port Elizabeth Camera Club

Committee & Editorial Team 2026

PECC Committee

Name	Role
Sydney Truter	President • 083 656 0330 Membership Secretary - pecc.members@gmail.com Events/Outings
Mayra Dold	Treasurer
Francois van Straten	Projectionist
Nyasha Godoka	Committee Member
Jinty Cuming	Refreshments
Rob Heffer	Auditor & Regional Director Eastern Cape
Charmaine Joubert	Club Log Administrator & Social Media
Julia Mukheibir	Secretary
Marise Ferreira	Committee Member
Jill Sneesby	Committee Member
Antionette Morkel	Committee Member

LUMEN Editorial Team

Name	Role
Port Elizabeth Camera Club	Publisher
Renée Santiago	Editor
Sydney Truter Marise Ferreira Charmaine Joubert	Contributors

A Special Thanks

Judges

Jill Sneesby
Kirk West

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Photographic Society of
South Africa



LUMEN

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From the President's Pen

Dear Members,

As we move into June, I want to thank each of you for the energy, creativity, and fellowship you bring to our Camera Club. Month after month, your images remind us that photography is more than a hobby—it is a way of seeing, storytelling, and sharing the beauty of the world around us.

This month I would especially like to remind everyone about our **Cellphone Photographic Competition**, which runs from **01 to 30 June**. This is a wonderful opportunity to prove that a powerful image does not depend on expensive equipment, but on creativity, timing, and vision. I encourage every member to take part, whether you are a seasoned photographer or just enjoy capturing everyday moments with your phone. Let this competition challenge you to see familiar subjects in fresh and exciting ways.

We are also delighted that our members' photographs will be showcased at the **Whale Festival on Sunday, 7 June**. This is a proud moment for our club and a wonderful chance to share our work with the wider community. I encourage members, family, and friends to attend, support the exhibition, and celebrate the talent within our club. Opportunities like this help us build visibility for the club while inspiring others through the art of photography.



From the President's Pen

Thank you for being part of this vibrant photographic community. I look forward to seeing you at the Whale Festival, and continuing to celebrate the creativity that makes our Camera Club so special.

Warm regards,

Sydney
Club President



Editor's Musings: The Gift of a Photograph

By Renée Santiago

Lately, as I have been spending time writing pieces of my memoir, I have found myself returning again and again to old photographs.

Some are clear and carefully composed. Others are faded, slightly crooked, or marked by the years. A few are not technically “good” photographs at all — someone’s head may be partly cut off, the light may be harsh, or the background may be cluttered with the ordinary evidence of daily life.

And yet, they are priceless.

I have become deeply thankful for my mother’s diligence in keeping our family photographs. Because she saved them, I can return to faces, places, rooms, clothing, expressions, and moments I might otherwise have forgotten. A photograph can unlock a memory that has been resting quietly for decades. It can bring back the shape of a kitchen, the way someone smiled, the feel of a Sunday afternoon, or the presence of someone no longer with us.

As photographers, we often think about impact, composition, light, sharpness, and story — and rightly so. These things help us grow in our craft. But sometimes the most important photograph is not the one that wins an award. Sometimes it is the simple family snapshot, the holiday meal, the child with messy hair, the old car in the driveway, the house before it changed, the hands of someone we loved.

We never really know which images will become treasures.

That is why photographing for memory matters. Not only the big events, but the small, everyday details that quietly form the story of a life. The shoes by the door. The table set for tea. A familiar garden. A beloved pet. A grandchild’s laugh. The ordinary things that one day may become extraordinary because they belong to a time we cannot return to.

In a world where we take so many photographs, perhaps the invitation is not only to take more, but to take them with intention — and to preserve them with care. Print a few. Label them. Back them up. Tell the story behind them. Because someday, someone may hold that photograph and say, “I am so thankful this was kept.” Photography is more than a hobby, more than competition, more than art alone.

It is memory made visible.

And sometimes, long after the moment has passed, a photograph becomes a doorway back to love.

With warm wishes,
Renée

Programme - June 2026

Upcoming Meetings, Judging Dates &
Club Events

What	When	Where
10 June	E Judging Category – Non manipulated/manipulated / Repetition images on Photo Vault	At 1 Dormy Place at 19:00/zoom
24 June	Last chance to submit photos for e-judging Colour and Monochrome/Manipulation Allowed / SS - Port Elizabeth	In PhotoVault before 23:50.

Beyond Looking: Photographing the Feeling of a Place

When a photograph becomes more than a record of what was there

By Renée Santiago

Inspired by the work of impressionist photographer Eva Polak

There is a difference between arriving with a camera and truly arriving with our senses awake.

As photographers, we are often trained to search quickly: a strong subject, good light, a balanced composition, a technically successful image. These things matter. But sometimes the photograph that stays with us is not the one that most accurately shows what stood before us. It is the one that somehow carries the feeling of being there.

I was recently drawn to a video by impressionist photographer Eva Polak on the difference between looking and seeing. Her approach is centred on impressionist photography, but the idea reaches far beyond any one style. Whether we photograph wildlife, landscapes, people, street scenes, abstracts or flowers, there is value in pausing long enough to ask:

What am I feeling in this place, and how might the photograph express it?

For me, this is often how I photograph. I am not always looking for a literal description of the scene. I am responding to the way light moves across water, the restlessness of a wave, the hush of colour, or the fleeting sense that a moment is disappearing even as I stand within it.

In these photographs, the sea was not simply a subject. It was movement, light, softness, energy and memory. The slower shutter speed allowed the water to become less of a record and more of an impression — not only what the ocean looked like, but something of what it felt like to stand beside it.

This way of photographing does not mean abandoning technique. Technique becomes the language through which the feeling is expressed. A sharp image may speak of clarity or stillness. A soft image may suggest tenderness. Motion blur may communicate energy, uncertainty or the passing of time.

Sometimes the first step toward a stronger photograph is not raising the camera.

Sometimes it is standing still.

A Creative Exercise: Photograph the Feeling

This exercise is not limited to impressionist photography. It can be used by any photographer, with any subject and any style. The purpose is simply to move beyond the quick record shot and become more aware of your own response to the scene.

Try This on Your Next Photographic Outing

1. Arrive before you photograph

When you reach your location, keep the camera lowered for a minute or two. Resist the urge to begin shooting immediately. Let yourself notice the atmosphere first.

2. Ask what the place feels like

Is it peaceful, lonely, joyful, restless, fragile, windswept, mysterious or full of movement? There is no correct answer. The feeling is personal.

3. Look for what expresses that feeling

Notice the light, colour, movement, texture or shape that seems to echo your response. It may be sunlight across a wall, wind in long grass, reflections on wet pavement, or the delicate movement of a wave.

4. Choose a technique that supports the mood

Your image does not have to be blurred or abstract. You might choose:

a slow shutter speed to suggest movement;

intentional camera movement for softness or energy;

a shallow depth of field to create intimacy;

strong contrast to express drama;

careful sharpness to communicate stillness or detail.

5. Make fewer, more intentional images

Instead of taking many quick photographs, wait for the moment when the light, movement and feeling seem to come together.

6. Review with a different question

When selecting your image, do not only ask, "Is it technically correct?" Ask:

"Does this image communicate something of what I felt?"

"I do not only want to photograph what a place looks like. I want to photograph what it feels like to be there."

2026 PSSA National Congress

Congress 2026: An Invitation to Participate

A Shared Opportunity

Congress 2026 offers more than a programme of events — it is an opportunity to engage, explore, and connect through photography. It brings together photographers at all levels, creating space to learn from one another, experience new perspectives, and spend time doing what we enjoy most — seeing and creating.

Guided Photoshoots

As part of this year's Congress, PECC members will be offering a series of guided photoshoots.

These sessions provide a relaxed and supportive environment to:

- explore different subjects and locations
- learn through shared experience
- observe how others approach a scene
- develop confidence in your own way of seeing

Why Take Part

Opportunities like this allow us to step outside our usual routines and approach photography with fresh perspective. It is often in these moments — trying something slightly different, or seeing alongside others — that growth naturally happens.

Looking Ahead

Further details regarding schedules, locations, and participation will be shared in the coming weeks.

Members are encouraged to consider how they might like to be involved — whether by joining a photoshoot, supporting activities, or simply attending and engaging with the experience.

Getting Involved

Watch for updates on photoshoots and activities

Consider how you would like to participate

Join in — even for a single session

For Your Diary

Please keep Congress 2026 in mind as plans develop. Your participation, in whatever form it takes, will contribute to making it a meaningful and enjoyable event for all.

We look forward to sharing this experience with you.

2026 PSSA National Congress

Congress 2026: An Invitation to Participate

Congress 2026: Planned Photoshoot Opportunities

- Sunrise at Shark Rock Pier
- Port Elizabeth Main Library and Cathedral Church of St Mary the Virgin, with an English gentleman model
- Free access to Cape Recife Lighthouse complex
- Horses and riders at PE Polocrosse Club, Kragga Kamma
- Porsche cars with models, motorbike riders, and beach sunset at Schoenmakerskop
- Beach horse ride at Sardinia Bay, with the option to arrive early for sunrise
- Sunrise in the harbour with fishing boats and yachts
- Air Force Museum
- Donkin Reserve, including the pyramid and lighthouse area
- Possible kite surfers, depending on weather conditions
- Sunrise, sunset, beach, and graffiti opportunities near Pine Lodge Resort

We look forward to sharing this experience with you.

Set Subjects: 2026 - 2027

All PECC club events have been opened on Photovault for members to view and upload their entries.

July - Port Elizabeth

Port Elizabeth-The aim is to capture an image that reflects the spirit and atmosphere of Port Elizabeth. The Locations must be identifiable. Colour and Monochrome | Manipulation Allowed

August - Artistic Animal Portraits

Artistic Animal Portraits-Create an artistic effect, emphasizing the character of the animal using texture, lighting & emotional expression either in shooting or post processing. Colour and Monochrome | Manipulation allowed

Best Senior Image Winner

“ I took this photograph while waiting for the sunrise of the rock being lapped by the sea on Gonubie beach.”

Wally also received a Certificate of Merit for this amazing photograph.



“Misty Morning” by Wally Devos

Camera Settings:

Camera Model: Pentax KP | Lens: Pentax 18-270 zoom | F-Stop: F25 | Exp: 20 sec. | ISO 20 | Length: 63 mm

Best Junior Image Winner



Thanks to everyone who voted for this image; it's one I personally really like as well.

This shot was taken in St. Ursula street Valletta Malta on an afternoon during a photo walk in late January this year.

I passed the gentleman in the shot whilst he was taking a photo of his salad with his phone as it was positioned exactly in the light on the edge the table. The light in the alley was somehow magically in that exact pocket. I positioned myself exposed for the highlights and waited a moment for him to start enjoying the salad he so coveted.

"Light Lunch" by Jay Nabbe

Camera Settings:

Camera Model: Canon EOS R6 | F-Stop: F8 | Exp: 1/320 sec. | ISO 100 | Focal Length: 35mm

Set Subject Winner

On the way to work I drove past this lovely oak tree and noticed that the leaves had not completely browned.

I decided that I wanted to do a simple pic on a black background. With that in mind I set up a small softbox with an off camera flash in my spare room and lay the leaves on a table draped with a black cloth.



“Almost Winter” by Alan Millard

Camera Settings:

Camera Model: Canon EOS 5D Mark III | F-Stop: F85.6 | Exp: 1/160 sec. | ISO 100 | Focal Length: 47 mm



Celebrating Our Members' Growth & Achievements

Every month, we celebrate the creativity and dedication of our members through awards that showcase growth and artistry.

Image of the Month

Author	Star	Title
Jay Nabbe	3	Light Lunch

Best Junior Picture

Author	Star	Title
Jay Nabbe	3	Light Lunch

Best 4,5 & H Star

Author	Star	Title
Wally Devos	5	Misty Morning

Set Subject: Autumn

Author	Star	Title
Alan Millard	3	Almost Winter

“We take photographs as a return ticket to a moment otherwise gone.”
— Katie Thurmes



Congratulations to all our members who received Gold awards this month .

Mark Thomson	2	At Speed
Sandra Roberts	2	Stormy Sunset
Alan Millard	3	Almost Winter
Alan Roberts	3	Stormy Autumn Clouds
Alan Roberts	3	Red Bull Aerobatics
Jaye Nabbe	3	Quietly Into The Light
Jaye Nabbe	3	Light Lunch
Nyasha Godoka	3	I Love the Way You Hold Me
Nyasha Godoka	3	Turning Beneath the Stars
Belita von Steiger	4	Liefde
Francois van Straten	4	Scary Seed Pod
Marise Ferreira	4	Rover Rider
Peter Robertson	4	Standing Paddle Boats
Peter Robertson	4	Karoo Windmill

Rick Payne	4	Blood Shot
Annemarie Robertson	5	Slow Down
Johan Jordaan	5	Springbokke Tweegeveg
Johan Jordaan	5	Visvanger Familie
Louis Lotter	5	When the Day Breaks Open
Louis Lotter	5	Spray of Glory
John Alexander	H	Art Deco Couple
Julia Mukheibir	H	Barn Owl
Julia Mekheibir	H	Black Sand and Mossy Slopes
Mayra Dold	H	A Naural Model
Mayra Dold	H	Intriqued
John Grosse	HGold	Banana 5

Set Subject Logs

	Shilhouettes	Neg Space	Trees & Forests	Fast in Focust	Multiple Exposures	Autumn	TOTAL
Names	Dec	Jan	Feb	Mar	April	May	
Louis Lotter	1	1	1	2	1	1	14
Mayra Dold	1	1	1	1	1	1	13
Frans van Heerden	1	1	1			1	12
John Grosse	1	1	3		3		12
Alison Duncan	1		1	3	1	1	11
Anette Reimers	1	1	2	1	1		11
Sydney Truter	1	1	1	1	1	1	11
Wally de Vos	1	1	1	1	1	1	11
Francois van Straten	1	1		1	1	1	10
Lea-Anne Alexander	1	1	1	1	1		10
Marise Ferreira		1	1	1	1		10
Mark Thomson	1	1	1	1	1	1	10
Alan Millard			1	1		3	9
Annemarie Robertson	1	3	1	1			9
Jay Nabbe	1	1	2	1	2		9

This page displays Set Subject results for the most recent six months of the PSSA / PECC club year (July to June).
The totals shown are cumulative and reflect results from the entire club year, not only the months displayed.

Set Subject Logs

	Shilhouettes	Neg Space	Trees & Forests	Fast in Focus	Multiple Exposures	Autumn	TOTAL
Names	Dec	Jan	Feb	Mar	April	May	
Nyasha Godoka	1	1	1	1			7
Alan Roberts	1	1	2				7
Julia Mukheibir	0	1	1			1	7
Gary Koekemoer	1		1	1		1	6
John Mills		1		1	1		5
Colin Lyall	3	0	0	1			4
Peter Robertson			1	1		1	4
Robert Heffer		1	1		1	1	4
Lynda Connellan			1	1		1	3
Sandra Roberts	2	1					3
Greg Fullard							2
Johan Jordaan	1						2
Maronel Steyn			1		1		2
Pieter Venter							2

Set Subject Logs

	Shilhouettes	Neg Space	Trees & Forests	Fast in Focus	Multiple Exposures	Autumn	TOTAL
Names	Dec	Jan	Feb	Mar	April	May	
Renske Jordaan							2
Belita von Steiger		1					1
Etienne Stassen							1
John Alexander							1
Rosalie Rothner							1

TOTAL CLUB POINTS



Name	Star Rating	Total Club Points
Jay Nabbe	3 Star	98
Johan Jordaan	5 Star	90
Louis Lotter	5 Star	86
Renske Jordaan	5 Star	85
Colin Lyall	4 Star	85
Mayra Dold	Honours	84
Nyasha Godoka	3 Star	77
Wally Devos	5 Star	74
Blayne Scholtz	4 star	74
Julia Mukheibir	Honours	73
John Grosse	HGold	72
Annmarie Robertson	5 Star	72
Alan Millard	3 Star	71



Name	Star Rating	Total Club Points
Frans van Heerden	4 Star	70
Francois van Straten	4 Star	69
Alison Duncan	5 Star	67
Lea-Anne Alexander	5 Star	66
Anette Reimers	Honours	66
Peter Robertson	4 Star	66
Mark Thomson	2 Star	63
Alan Roberts	3 Star	61
Rick Payne	4 Star	58
Sydney Truter	4 Star	58
Robert Heffer	5 Star	55
John Alexander	Honours	47



Name	Star Rating	Total Club Points
John Mills	5 Stars	46
Marise Ferreira	4 Star	41
Gary Koekemoer	4 Star	34
Etienne Stassen	5 Star	33
Pieter Venter	4 Star	33
Blayne Scholtz	4 Star	30
Maronel Steyn	2 Star	28
Sandra Roberts	2 Star	27
Lynda Connellan	4 Star	18
Matthijis Ravensberg	4 Star	7
Greg Fullard	2 Star	5
Rosalie Rother	2 Star	5

Join the PECC Creative Circle

Be part of a welcoming photographic community where learning, creativity, outings, competitions, workshops, and friendships come together.

Whether you are just beginning or have years of experience behind the lens, PECC offers a place to grow, share, and be inspired.



Membership Subscriptions 2026 **Annual Membership Options**

(R50 Joining Fee per person)

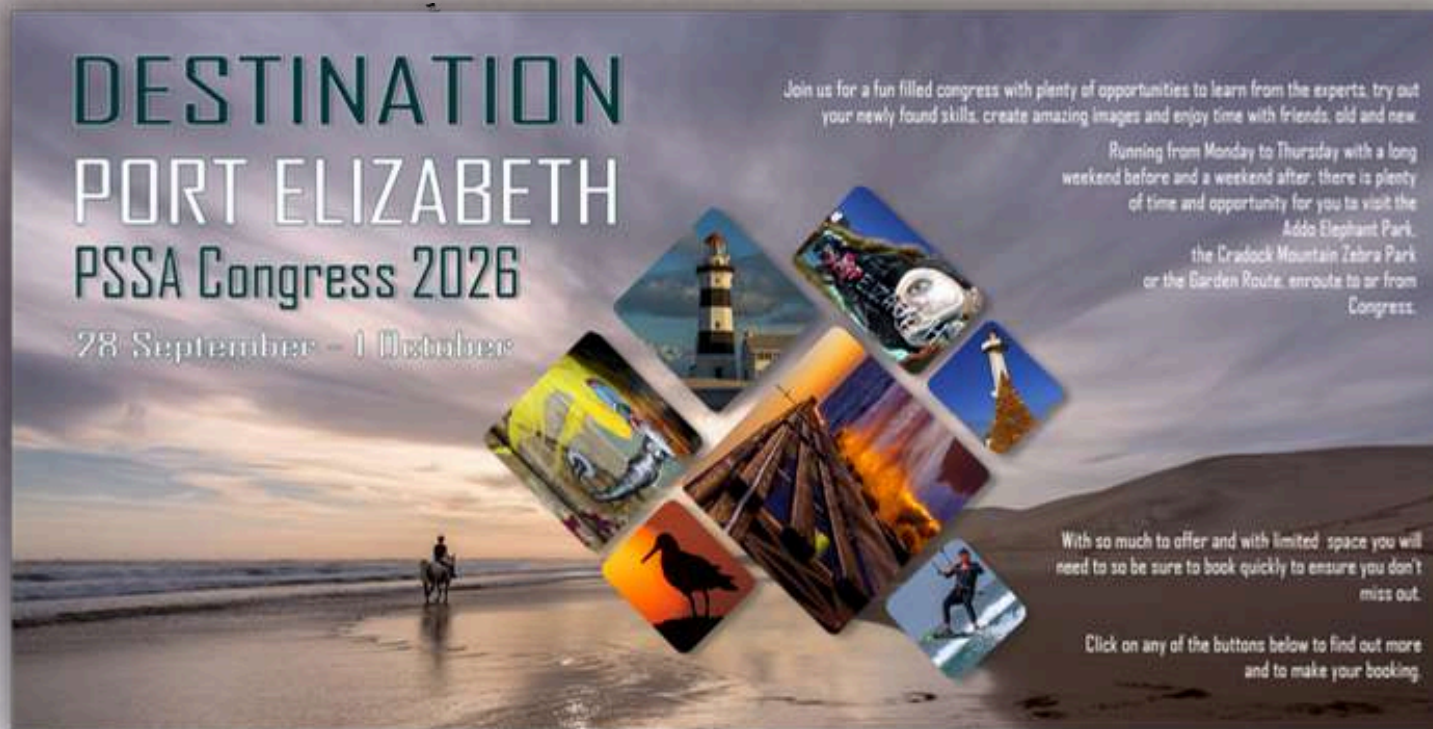
Individual Membership	R510
Family Membership	R560
Student/Retired Membership	R430
Retired Family Membership	R480



We'd love to welcome you!

For questions or to sign up, reach out to
pecameraclub@gmail.com





Set this time apart.

September is calling...

A time to step away from the ordinary and into something inspiring.

Join us in Port Elizabeth for a gathering of creativity, connection, and growth.

A space to learn, to share, to see differently—and to be renewed through the lens.

Make it more than a few days.

Make it an experience.

Mark your calendar. Protect the time. Come be part of it.